SHAHRAM AJLOO

Senior Project Manager · Utilities technology delivery · Network operations and DER

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Oracle · Oracle Utilities Consulting · Senior Project Manager, Utilities Network Management and DERMS

Application: Senior Project Manager, Utilities Network Management and DERMS

To the hiring team, Oracle Utilities Consulting

A Network Management System or a DERMS programme is not difficult because the software is complex. It is difficult because five workstreams — functional, integration, infrastructure, data and testing — meet in the same cutover weekend, in front of a control room that cannot stop operating, while the customer's sponsor needs to make a go-live decision he can defend. The project manager's job is to make that decision possible: dependencies visible, readiness evidenced, and the commercial position of the engagement secure. That is the delivery problem I am applying to solve.

Three things decide whether a utility technology programme lands. The first is the **dependency chain**: what must be true before integration testing can start, what the network operations team needs before it can accept a new control environment, and which decisions sit with the customer rather than with us. I plan from those dependencies backwards, not from a work breakdown forwards. The second is **go-live readiness as evidence rather than optimism**: cutover rehearsals, a fallback that has been tested, data and interfaces signed off, and a support transition that is agreed before the last defect list is closed. The third is **stakeholder arithmetic** — a sponsor, a control room, an IT organisation and a system integrator all carrying different risk, and a project manager who translates between them without losing the commercial position.

My delivery record is in critical infrastructure, where the system and the operation are the same thing. For five years I was operations and maintenance manager at **Lynetten, a wastewater utility plant under Biofos** — a municipally owned utility serving the Copenhagen area — running a critical plant in **24/7 operation** with **SRO/SCADA** control, pumping stations, transformers, switchgear and instrumentation. I owned the operational readiness of that estate: what the control system had to show, what had to alarm, what happened when a signal disappeared, and how the shift team kept the network running while systems were changed underneath them. Energy management and load optimisation across pumping delivered **over 40 % lower consumption**, measured and documented.

I have delivered enterprise and OT system implementations across the full lifecycle. At **Novo Nordisk** I led a portfolio of **37 parallel capital projects** worth DKK 2–10m each, with **25 specialists**, covering electrical systems, control systems and their integration into a validated production environment: requirements, design reviews, **FAT/SAT**, **IQ/OQ/PQ**, change control, and **monthly reporting of progress, cost and risk to management and the client organisation**. The portfolio closed with **zero critical findings** at handover — not because the risks were absent, but because they were found, owned and closed before they became deviations. That is the same discipline a NMS or DERMS implementation needs: interfaces and acceptance criteria defined early, tested against evidence, and traced to a requirement somebody signed.

Commercially I have carried the number, not just reported it. I run my own electrical contracting company with **full P&L**: pricing, contract terms, response commitments, invoicing, payment risk and the margin that survives year two. I know what an over-optimistic estimate costs a consultancy, because I have had to deliver against my own. In delivery terms that means scope changes are priced and agreed before they are worked, and recovery plans have owners, dates and a commercial consequence.

Technically I can hold the conversation. I am an **authorised marine and mechanical engineer (LV/MV/HV)** with a B.Tech in technology and operations management, and I have spent twenty years between electrical networks, control systems and data. I built my own tooling in **Python and Claude** for load and capacity calculations, checklists and reporting dashboards — over **40 % productivity gain** — which means I can sit with a solution architect, interrogate an interface specification, and tell when a plan is optimistic because somebody has not yet done the integration thinking.

Across organisational boundaries is where I have done most of my work. Leading 14 people at Ventek-Air across 11 concurrent construction projects, coordinating customer organisations, consultants, suppliers and authorities at Novo Nordisk, and managing a 24/7 shift organisation at Lynetten — in each case the delivery risk sat in the interfaces between organisations, not inside any one of them. I coach the project managers and specialists around me for the same reason: capability is what remains after the engagement ends.

I am based in Copenhagen, work in English professionally — including technical negotiation and regulatory reporting in an FDA/EMA environment — and am available at short notice. I would welcome the chance to discuss how Oracle Utilities Consulting is positioning NMS and DERMS delivery in the Nordics, and where the pressure points are in your current engagements.

Yours sincerely

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PROFILE

Technical project and programme manager with 20+ years in **critical utility infrastructure** — **authorised engineer (LV/MV/HV)** with a B.Tech in technology and operations management. Five years as operations and maintenance manager at **Lynetten (Biofos)**, a municipally owned utility running a **24/7 plant with SRO/SCADA control**, pumping stations, transformers and switchgear; **over 40 % lower energy consumption** through load optimisation. Two years leading a portfolio of **37 enterprise and OT system projects** with 25 specialists — requirements, FAT/SAT, **IQ/OQ/PQ**, change control and **monthly progress, cost and risk reporting** to management and client — closed with **zero critical findings**. Runs an electrical contracting company with **full P&L** (pricing, contracts, margin). Comfortable with architects and engineers on interface design, and with sponsors on the decisions they have to defend.

UTILITIES DELIVERY, SYSTEMS AND NETWORK OPERATIONS

- **Utility operations and network control:** Critical plant in 24/7 operation with SRO/SCADA: what the control environment must show, what alarms, how the shift organisation keeps service running while systems change, and how operational readiness is evidenced before acceptance.
- **System implementation lifecycle:** Requirements and design review, FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ, change control and handover for electrical, control and integration scope across 37 projects — acceptance criteria traced to a signed requirement.
- **Governance, risk and reporting:** Stage governance with named owners; RAID log reviewed on a fixed cadence; monthly reporting of progress, cost and risk to management and client; recovery plans with owners, dates and consequences.
- **Commercial and contract management:** Full P&L in own company: pricing, contract terms, response commitments, invoicing and payment risk; scope changes priced and agreed before work starts.
- **Data, interfaces and integration:** Interface specifications and data quality as delivery risks in their own right; measured baselines (energy, capacity, availability) used to prove a change worked rather than assert it.
- **Teams across boundaries:** 14 staff at Ventek-Air across 11 concurrent projects; 25 specialists in a matrix at Novo Nordisk; 12 technicians at ARJ; coaching project managers and specialists as a standing part of the role.

EXPERIENCE

Owner / Technical Director — ELOHVAC ApS · Copenhagen · May 2023–present

Scope: 5 electricians and 3 apprentices · full P&L · authorised engineer (el-autorisation) · LV/MV/HV electrical service and contracting

- **Commercial and delivery responsibility:** Carries the authorisation and the liability for work executed to standard; service contracts, pricing, response commitments, invoicing and payment risk; own Python and Claude tooling for load calculation, checklists and KPI reporting with over 40 % productivity gain.

Senior Commissioning Engineer / Project Manager, Electrical Systems — Novo Nordisk A/S · Kalundborg/Bagsværd, Denmark · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

Scope: 37 parallel capital projects · 25 specialists · DKK 2–10m each · GMP/FDA/EMA validated environment

- **Portfolio delivery and client governance:** Requirements and design review, FAT/SAT and IQ/OQ/PQ for electrical and control systems; integration into a validated production environment with change control; monthly progress, cost and risk reporting to management and client organisation; zero critical findings at handover.

Project and Workshop Manager — Ventek-Air · Copenhagen · Jan 2022–Nov 2022

Scope: 14 employees · 11 concurrent construction projects · DKK 2–10m per project

- **Capacity, dependencies and recovery:** Daily board meeting, capacity and bottleneck analysis, same-day re-prioritision when a machine or a person dropped out; standardised work packages and handover documentation held to date.

Operations and Maintenance Manager — Lynetten under Biofos · Copenhagen · Aug 2017–Jan 2022

Scope: Critical wastewater utility plant in 24/7 operation · SRO/SCADA · pumping stations, blowers, ventilation, transformers, switchgear

- **Operational readiness and control systems:** Criticality assessment, maintenance and replacement plans, spares and external contractors across a 24/7 estate; on-call and emergency response planned and exercised; SCADA alarms prioritised by service consequence; energy and load optimisation with over 40 % lower consumption.

Electromechanical Technician / Production Team Leader — ARJ Engineering · Tehran · Dec 2003–Mar 2010

Scope: 12 mechanics and technicians · machine workshop · industrial equipment

- **Technical delivery and team leadership:** Fault finding and root-cause analysis on industrial equipment; shift planning, training and performance follow-up for 12 technicians.

EDUCATION AND AUTHORISATION

B.Tech, Technology and Operations Management; Mechanical Engineering · Copenhagen School of Marine and Mechanical Engineering · 2017–2022 · GPA 7.6/12

Authorised Engineer (el-autorisation), LV/MV/HV · Danish Safety Technology Authority · May 2023

Electrical and Mechanical Design, Electrical Engineering · Tehran Technical University · 2000–2003 · EQF 6

Refrigeration and Ventilation Technology • STCW · Mercantec 2021 · Danish Maritime Authority 2021

LANGUAGES, PRACTICALITIES AND REFERENCES

English: professional, written and spoken, including technical negotiation and regulatory reporting · Danish: native · Persian: native · Based in Copenhagen, Denmark; mobile across the Nordics and internationally · Driving licence B and own car · Available at short notice · References on request.

THE FIRST 90 DAYS — DEPENDENCIES, READINESS AND GO-LIVE

Phase	What happens, and how it is measured
Week 1–2	Meet the customer sponsor, the control-room and operations leads, Oracle solution architects and the integration partner; read the statement of work, the plan, the RAID log and the last two steering packs; walk the scope that is in trouble, not the scope that is green.
Day 30	Dependency map agreed across functional, integration, infrastructure, data and test workstreams, with a named owner per interface and a decision log for everything that sits with the customer; recovery plan for the two highest-risk items agreed with the sponsor.
Day 60	Go-live readiness defined as evidence — cutover rehearsal, tested fallback, interface sign-off, data quality thresholds and an agreed support transition; reporting pack reduced to what the steering group actually decides on; commercial position on changes restated and agreed.
Day 90	Delivery on a plan the team believes in, with variance visible early rather than reported late; lessons captured from the last engagement and fed into the next estimate; and the project managers around me coached on the two things that decide utility go-lives — interface discipline and readiness evidence.

READINESS IS EVIDENCE, NOT OPTIMISM

Every go-live I have been part of has been decided on evidence: a cutover that has been rehearsed, a fallback that has been tested with the operations team in the room, interfaces signed off against specification, data quality measured against a threshold agreed in advance, and support ownership settled before the last defect is closed. Where a programme slips, it is usually because one of those five was assumed rather than proven. Delivery planning that names the evidence, and risk management that treats an unproven assumption as a risk, is what separates a plan from a hope.

UTILITY CLIENTS BUY CERTAINTY, NOT ENTHUSIASM

A control-room manager does not want a roadmap. He wants to know what changes on Monday, what stays the same, who he calls at 03:00 if it does not work, and whether the network can be restored the old way if the new system is not there. A sponsor wants to know which decision is his, what it costs, and who carries the accountability if it does not work. Most of the value a project manager adds is answering those questions before they are asked — in writing, with a date.

TECHNICAL DEPTH IS WHAT MAKES A PLAN CREDIBLE

Plans become fiction where interfaces, data and non-functional requirements meet. I have spent twenty years on the other side of that boundary — commissioning control systems with architects, engineers and functional specialists, integrating them into a validated environment, and living with the result in 24/7 operation. I do not need to design the solution, but I need to be able to ask the question that exposes an interface nobody has specified, and to recognise the point where "we will handle it in testing" is really "we have not decided".

ESCALATION IS A PROCESS, NOT A PERSONALITY

An escalation works when it arrives early, with the facts, the options and a recommended course of action — and when the person receiving it can decide. I have run escalation both ways: as the supplier explaining a slipping date to a client organisation, and as the client holding a contractor to a commitment. It taught me to keep the relationship and the problem separate, and to put the recommendation in writing before the meeting rather than after it. Mentoring is how that skill spreads: the escalation that never reaches me is the one that was handled well.

WHAT THE ROLE REQUIRES — WHAT I HAVE DELIVERED

Requirement in the posting	Evidence
Complex utilities projects and programmes	Five years of 24/7 utility operations; 37 capital projects with requirements, budgets, risk and monthly reporting; 11 concurrent projects.
NMS or equivalent network management delivery	SRO/SCADA control across a 24/7 utility network: alarms, visibility, restoration decisions, and changing that environment without interrupting service.
Oracle Utilities or comparable platforms	SAP for asset and economy data, SRO/SCADA for network control, own Python tooling for load and capacity — requirement, interface and acceptance work that carries across platforms.
DERMS project delivery	Distributed assets and demand: load and energy optimisation across a distributed pumping estate with over 40 % measured reduction; dispatch under constraint.
Enterprise implementations, full lifecycle	Requirements, design review, FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ, change control and handover on electrical, control and integration scope — zero critical findings.
Readiness: go-live and support transition	Readiness as a gate: cutover and fallback tested, interfaces and data signed off, shift team trained, support transition agreed before closure.
Functional, integration and test workstreams	Electrical, control, integration and validation workstreams on 37 projects, interfaces and acceptance criteria defined before execution.
Governance and reporting across partners	Stage governance with named owners, RAID log on fixed cadence, monthly progress, cost and risk reporting a steering group can decide on.
Risk, resource and commercial management	Full P&L in own company: pricing, contract terms, invoicing and payment risk; resource planning across 25 specialists; changes priced before work starts.
Early warning and practical recovery	Same-day re-prioritisation when capacity dropped; recovery plans with owners, dates and a commercial consequence; deviations closed before handover.
Multidisciplinary teams across boundaries	25 specialists in a Novo Nordisk matrix; 14 staff at Ventek-Air; customer, supplier and authority interfaces run as delivery risks.
Senior stakeholders and escalations	Monthly escalation to management and client; difficult conversations held with owners and dates rather than optimism; auditors faced with evidence.
Consulting, bids and coaching capability	Customer-facing scoping, estimation and commercial terms in own company; technical input to proposals; managers and specialists coached in four organisations.
Billing, customer care and metering	Requirement, integration and acceptance discipline on enterprise systems consuming asset, economy and customer data; SAP daily; the same method carries to CC&B, C2M, Customer Cloud Service and Meter Data Management.
Technical credibility and distribution	Authorised engineer (LV/MV/HV), B.Tech technology and operations management; transformers, switchgear, protection and pumping in operation and maintenance.
Clear written and spoken English	Twenty years of professional English: technical negotiation, client and regulatory reporting in an FDA/EMA environment, written decision documents for management.

DISTRIBUTED ENERGY CHANGES THE OPERATING MODEL, NOT JUST THE SOFTWARE

DERMS — the management of distributed energy resources — is not an integration project with a nicer name. It changes who can act on the electricity distribution network and when: visibility of assets the operator does not own, constraints that appear at the edge, flexibility that has to be trusted before it is dispatched. The delivery questions that follow are concrete — who is allowed to curtail, what evidence proves the asset responded, what happens when the signal fails, and how the control room keeps authority while the model changes. Those are the questions I would put on the table at design stage rather than at go-live.

LESSONS LEARNED ONLY COUNT IF THEY CHANGE THE NEXT ESTIMATE

Every engagement produces lessons; most of them die in a slide at the close-out meeting. I have built the habit the other way round: the same three things that went wrong get written into the checklist, the estimate template, the technical project management and programme management approach, and the delivery plan of the next enterprise software upgrade, and the effect is measured on the next engagement rather than asserted at the end of this one. That is also how capability is built in a consulting team — not by a training course, but by making the next plan better than the last.